

customers, so you are only suggesting products to them that you know they are interested in. This can be really useful if you ever think about starting up your own business or affiliate program.

Second retailers use personalisation APIs to use an API that helps them understand your interests from your other web and social media behaviour. These APIs use complex algorithms to reorder your website content so that it matches what you may have posted on other social media channels or have been searching on Google.

Using APIs

The simplest way to use an API to find what you want(especially if the product is highly specific or has to meet a certain budgetary constraint) is by first visiting the website of the marketplace from where the product is to be bought.

Take a look at the search bar and see the number of search bars, checkboxes, radio buttons, drop-down menus and search through any random products. Gain an understanding of the familiar products that appear on hitting the search bar and what follows on the search result pages.

Familiarise yourself with the requirements for the CTO you would be interested in and then keep in mind the following components for any API:-

Integrations — keep the API in sync with your systems. Modern applications can talk to each other using the REST protocol and so should the API platform you want to use. On top of that, the API vendor should give you any import/export tools and other built-in integrations for the system you already use. This can save you thousands in software development.

Webhooks — this is another feature to keep your data in sync. It streamlines the notifications the API sends during important tasks such as a component failing, or a new lead has appeared. It is also useful when you are thinking about using integration marketplaces like Zapier or IFTTT.

Role-based access control — this is self-explanatory. Big teams almost always require mapping of their workflows by using system rights and workflows. The API platform should let you control access read/edit rights by administrators.

Audit logs— as an extension of the previous point, a security and compliance team will control and monitor all information access to make sure that any API vendor you want to work with supports this too.

Reporting — reports actually demonstrate real value gained from the use of an application. The API platform should offer flexible reporting